

Vegas, was the first to legalise and regulate online gambling. Incidentally, hosting an online gambling site back in 2001 meant coughing up half a million dollars in license fees and then \$250,000 every year afterwards!

August 29: SATA

The Serial ATA specifications were released at the Intel Developer Forum (IDF). Serial ATA (SATA) would eventually replace Parallel ATA (PATA) as the standard for connecting devices to the motherboard in the average home PC. Advantages include higher bandwidth, smaller connectors, fewer pins and thinner cables to make the insides of our cabinets more manageable, also improving motherboard design and making in-cabinet heat dissipation simpler. Currently, the most popular interface is revision 2 of SATA, which offers 300 MBps transfer rates.

September 6: The HP-Compaq deal

Hewlett-Packard (HP) announced that it planned to buy Compaq in a stock-for-stock deal that would cost them about 25 billion dollars (1 lakh crore rupees). This deal made HP-Compaq the largest PC manufacturer in the world, and also the world leader in printing solutions.

September 25: Puma follows Cheetah

Apple followed up Mac OS X 10.1 (Cheetah) with 10.2 (Puma). This upgrade was significantly better than Cheetah, and brought with it better performance and filled in the cracks in Cheetah—DVD playback being the most important. A significant visual change also occurred, when the start up screen saw the death of the “Happy Mac” icon to a prettier and more sober grey Apple start up icon. The Happy Mac icon was something Apple users had seen at their start up screens for over 18 years—aeons in terms of technology businesses!

October 23: The day of the pod

Apple announced the release of its portable media player called the iPod. Today, the iPod remains the highest-selling portable